

M09 PROTECTED PRACTICE REVIEW

Open only after a genuine saved decision artifact

Diagnose -> close review -> changed artifact -> validate -> append evidence.

IBA1 review - Stakeholder request -> decision-focused Analysis Brief

1. Strong attempt should show

A second analyst can state the decision, analytical question, scope, comparison and Definition of Done without asking what you meant.

2. Expected reasoning

Analysis starts with the decision, not the columns. Separate the business concern from the analytical question; specify comparison, period, scope, metric meaning, exclusions, assumptions and what would count as decision-ready evidence.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the brief is vague, circle the verb in the stakeholder request. Ask: what decision will be made differently? Then rewrite the request as one decision and one analytical question.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA2 review - KPI trees, metric definitions and driver logic

1. Strong attempt should show

Two analysts using your definitions would calculate the same numerator, denominator, exclusions and scope; weighted rates are not replaced by averages of subgroup rates.

2. Expected reasoning

A KPI tree is a diagnostic map, not a causal diagram. Every rate needs numerator, denominator, scope and exclusions. Driver metrics help locate movement; they do not automatically explain why it moved.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If KPI results disagree, stop analysis and audit definition, numerator, denominator, exclusions, time window and grain. Do not average rates unless weighting is mathematically valid.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA3 review - Analysis planning and prioritization

1. Strong attempt should show

Every planned analysis has a decision reason and a validation method. Removing a low-value cut would not weaken the decision.

2. Expected reasoning

Prioritize questions by decision impact, evidence availability and reversibility. A hypothesis is something to test, not an answer you are trying to prove. Attach a validation check to every material output before you open the tool.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the plan becomes a list of every possible slice, score each question on decision impact and evidence availability. Keep only the cuts that can change an action.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA4 review - Diagnostic analysis: comparison, trend, segment and variance

1. Strong attempt should show

Segment totals reconcile to the whole, periods/denominators are comparable, and the priority gap is material rather than merely visually dramatic.

2. Expected reasoning

Diagnose from whole -> comparison -> trend -> segment -> variance. Compare like-for-like periods and denominators. Segment only where different findings could lead to different actions, and reconcile segment totals to the whole.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If segments do not reconcile, check filters, denominator/grain, duplicate rows and time windows before interpreting. If one segment looks extreme, compare its size and persistence before prioritizing.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA5 review - Root-cause discipline and causal boundaries

1. Strong attempt should show

Every causal word is supported by the evidence design. Association is labelled as association; competing explanations and missing data are visible.

2. Expected reasoning

Use claim levels deliberately: descriptive pattern -> suggestive association -> causal evidence. Observational comparisons can narrow hypotheses, but strong causal wording requires a design that addresses alternative explanations.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If you catch yourself writing because, caused, drives or leads to, rewrite the claim at the evidence level you actually have and list at least one plausible confounder or alternative mechanism.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA6 review - Observation -> insight -> implication

1. Strong attempt should show

Each insight contains comparison, magnitude, scope and why it matters. It does not simply rename a chart or restate a number.

2. Expected reasoning

Observation says what happened. Insight says why the pattern matters in context. Implication says what the evidence means for the decision. Strong insights include comparison, magnitude, scope and a causal boundary.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If an insight is just a metric, add versus what, by how much, where/when and what decision it changes. If you cannot add those, you may only have an observation.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA7 review - Recommendations that can actually be executed

1. Strong attempt should show

The named owner could start tomorrow and knows what success means, what could go wrong and when the recommendation should be reconsidered.

2. Expected reasoning

A recommendation is not advice such as improve operations. It is owner + action + scope + timing + success measure + risk/dependency + next validation. Expected benefit is a measurable hypothesis, not a promise.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the recommendation is generic, force five fields: owner, first action, scope/time, success metric and risk/stop condition. Remove any promised benefit that the evidence cannot support.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA8 review - Executive writing: headline, evidence and one-page memo

1. Strong attempt should show

The first three sentences are useful on their own; evidence supports the headline; methodology does not crowd out the decision; limitations are proportionate.

2. Expected reasoning

Executive communication leads with the decision-relevant message. Use 2-4 strongest evidence points, put method detail in backup unless it changes interpretation, and state limitations that constrain the action.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the memo starts with method or is longer than the decision needs, rewrite the headline as a complete message sentence, keep 2-4 evidence bullets and move detail to backup.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA9 review - Data storytelling and visual hierarchy

1. Strong attempt should show

The audience can identify the main message of each page/slide within seconds. Every visual earns its place and reconciles to the validated analysis.

2. Expected reasoning

Exploration and explanation are different jobs. A story removes outputs that do not serve the decision, uses message headlines, directs attention with position/annotation/contrast and gives each slide/page one main point.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the story looks like a dashboard screenshot, write the decision sequence first, then choose one visual per message. Remove decorative elements and annotate the evidence that matters.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA10 review - Stakeholder defense: questions, pushback and uncertainty

1. Strong attempt should show

You can reproduce the challenged definition/filter/reconciliation and distinguish known, uncertain and unsupported claims without changing the story to win the argument.

2. Expected reasoning

When challenged, answer the question first, then show evidence. Separate a definition dispute from a calculation error. Reproduce the logic; say I do not know yet when the data cannot support a stronger answer.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If a stakeholder challenge exposes a real definition/calculation error, correct it and update the decision log. If it exposes uncertainty, state what additional evidence would resolve it.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.

IBA11 review - Integrated case: analysis -> decision -> communication

1. Strong attempt should show

A reviewer can trace every recommendation backward to validated evidence and every material number back to a definition, grain and validation record.

2. Expected reasoning

The finished workflow is request -> decision -> question -> metric definition -> data/grain -> validation -> analysis -> observation -> insight -> implication -> recommendation -> owner/success/risk -> communication -> decision log.

3. What to compare

Compare decision/question, metric definition, grain/scope, validation, causal wording and traceability before exact wording/layout. Equivalent artifacts are valid when the evidence chain is sound.

4. Likely repair

If the case feels overwhelming, return to the evidence chain and find the first broken arrow. Repair that dependency rather than polishing downstream slides.

5. Fresh retry

Close this review. Complete the changed task from the direct IBA worksheet. Append new evidence and defend it without answer material.